Corrected lexical fallback: Methodology and Evidence

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Status. Post-run methodology reconstruction grounded in archived source and reports. This document is not an executed historical notebook.

Research question

Retain a simple valid submission path if the neural scorer fails to load. The fallback uses no adapted retrieval checkpoint, so it is a useful control against the more complex neural systems.

Architecture and mechanism

Corrected lexical ranking excludes the query itself, checks pool membership and uniqueness, and emits exactly seven candidate IDs.

Measured result

Scored submission	1039899, 1039901
Codabench micro-F1@7	0.4022
Archived local metric	not independently reported after correction

Its Codabench micro-F1@7 was 0.4022, near the corrected neural runs. This shows the lexical signal remained strong on this task.

Limitations and next check

It does not demonstrate that lexical matching understands legal entailment or precedent relevance. Local, pilot, and hidden metrics are deliberately kept distinct. A single scored run does not establish a causal architecture effect or statistical significance.

Source and reproducibility

Original source modules: phase7_export.py, phase7_run.py. SHA-256 hashes, the original report, and the prediction ZIP receipt are in the companion provenance file. The explanatory notebook was written after the historical run; original execution output is never implied. Reproduction requires authorized course data, the Phase 1 parent weights/tokenizer, and the dependencies in the archived source.

Documentation disclosure

AI assistance was used to organize the archived evidence and draft this explanatory document. All numerical claims above come from saved run records or the provided finished-submission screenshot; missing evidence is labelled as such.